



South Asian Network of Grassroots Agricultural Museums
Preserving Living Agricultural Heritage Across South Asia

FELLOWSHIP GUIDELINES

About the SANGAM Fellowship

The SANGAM Fellowship is open to researchers, academics, heritage scholars, oral historians, ethnographers, archivists, digital heritage professionals and anyone working at the intersection of agriculture, community knowledge and living heritage. The fellowship is not confined to any single discipline — SANGAM welcomes proposals from any field that engages seriously with agricultural heritage, food traditions, rural knowledge systems, seed culture, material culture, folk practices and lived community experience.

Fellows contribute to SANGAM's documentation, research and knowledge-building work and are connected to the wider SANGAM network of museums, institutions and heritage practitioners across South Asia.

Fellowship Tracks

Applicants may indicate one primary track. Proposals that span multiple tracks or fall outside these categories are also welcome — if your work engages with heritage, agriculture and lived community knowledge, we want to hear from you.

Open to **researchers, academics, heritage scholars, oral historians, ethnographers, archivist and digital heritage professionals** interested in contributing to SANGAM's work of researching, documenting, preserving and sharing South Asia's agricultural heritage.

The fellowship supports an **interconnected range of research and documentation practices**, bringing together field-based enquiry, community knowledge and digital preservation. Fellows may explore subjects such as **agricultural heritage, seed histories and crop traditions, traditional tools and technologies, farming practices, food traditions, oral histories, small and community museum collections, material culture and changing rural landscapes**. They may undertake field documentation with farmers, artisans, knowledge holders, communities, museums and other custodians of agricultural heritage.

The fellowship also encourages fellows to explore ways of **preserving and making this knowledge accessible digitally** through documentation, archival digital collections and online presentation. All digital collections will be hosted on the SANGAM website. The aim is to connect research and field documentation with meaningful forms of digital heritage preservation, ensuring that the knowledge and narratives gathered through the fellowship can contribute to SANGAM's wider research and knowledge-building efforts.

Possible areas of engagement include:

- Agricultural heritage, seed histories and crop traditions
- Traditional tools, technologies and material culture
- Oral histories, community memories and local knowledge
- Ethnographic and field-based documentation
- Food traditions, festivals and agricultural practices
- Digital documentation, archiving and online Presentation
- Research that contributes to SANGAM's wider documentation and knowledge network

Key Guidelines for submitting the Proposal

Word Limit	2,000 – 2,500 words (excluding bibliography)
Language	English
Format	PDF or Word (.docx) File name: FirstName_LastName_SANGAM_Fellowship_2026
Submit to	info@sangam.asia
Subject Line	SANGAM Fellowship Application 2026 — [Your Name] — [Fellowship Track]
Attachments	Completed Application Form + Research Proposal + Bio of fellow as separate documents
Duration	6 months

Research Proposal Structure

Your research proposal (2,000–2,500 words, excluding bibliography) must follow the structure below. Please ensure each section is clearly labelled.

- **Title of the Proposal**
- **Abstract:** 150 to 200 words summarising the proposal
- **Background & Context:** situate your work within existing knowledge and identify the gap your proposal addresses
- **Objectives:** Clearly state the aims and specific objectives of your proposed work
- **Methodology:** describe your research or documentation approach, methods, fieldwork plan, community engagement strategy and tools or frameworks you intend to use
- **Relevance to Agricultural Heritage:** explain how your work connects to South Asia's living agricultural heritage and to SANGAM's mission
- **Expected Outcomes & Deliverables:** describe what you will produce: a report, field documentation, digital collection / online archive, publication, exhibition material or other output
- **Timeline:** a brief month-by-month work plan for the fellowship period
- **Bibliography:** list of references and sources cited (not counted in word limit)

What We Look For

SANGAM reviews all fellowship proposals with the following criteria in mind:

- Clear connection to agricultural heritage, food traditions or lived community knowledge
- Rigour and clarity of the research or documentation approach
- Potential contribution to the SANGAM network and its knowledge base
- Feasibility of the proposed work within the fellowship period
- Commitment to community-centred, respectful and ethical field engagement

What Fellows Do

- Contribute original research, documentation or digital heritage work to the SANGAM knowledge archive

- Participate in SANGAM programmes — Talks, Film Festival, Exhibitions and field documentation projects
- Share work-in-progress updates with the SANGAM advisory team
- Present work at a SANGAM Talk or event during or after the fellowship period
- Submit a final report or deliverable at the close of the fellowship
- Participate in Conferences and workshops
- Publish in Journals and Periodicals
- Write articles/blogs/ podcasts

What Fellows Get

- A fellowship of Rs. 1,00,000 (INR 1lakh)
- Certificate after the completion of Fellowship
- Citation in of SANGAM's Publication
- An invitation to future events, conferences, seminar, podcast organized by SANGAM